



Write to the Editor

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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. **You must include your complete address in all communication.**

For subscription queries, call the help desk at 022-27629191/9200, fax 022-27629224, or send an e-mail to help@jasubhai.com

Inbox

Mobile Reviews Please!

Thanks to Team Digit for providing an ocean of knowledge for readers like me. A request on my behalf: I am crazy about mobiles! I have searched different magazines but not found enough information. I am waiting for an issue of *Digit* that will review mobile phones the way you tested digital cameras, graphics cards and personal computers.

Pratiush Kumar Singh, Patna

Dear Pratiush,
We have already carried a mobile phone review for the high-end category in October 2005—hope you read it. The category will be revisited in a few months, so do watch out for it in future issues of *Digit*.

—Associate Editor

Simple And Effective

Thanks for everything. I am an engineer, and am very interested in PC stuff and software. Initially I had just a drop of knowledge, but after I picked up *Digit*, I'm the best among my mates in terms of sheer knowledge, and win many group discussions about PC and software. All the credit goes to my hard work! Hey, I'm just kidding—it goes to you!

I have been reading *Digit* for the past three years, and it's really worth it. The way your articles are written, I just can't put it down mid-way.

Jassie Dhaliwal, Bhatinda

Dear Jassie,
Thanks for your appreciation. If *Digit* has made you a champ in group discussions on technology, then we're proud to have done our job well—damn well, I guess!

Letters such as yours motivate us to continue working hard towards providing not just the latest but also lasting information on technology to our readers.

—Associate Editor

More About Online Certificate Programmes

I would like to request you to include an article on online certifications such as RHCE, RHCT, MCSE, CCNA, CCNP, etc.

I'd appreciate it if you could also talk about the validity of these in UPSC examinations (if a degree is not obtained), along with its cost, and where to study it.

Bapi Roy, West Bengal

Dear Bapi,
We have initiated writing articles on careers in the IT and ITES industries; this month, we've covered career aspects in BPO setups. Soon, we will also delve into the qualifications required to enter the IT sector. Keep an eye out for those!

— Associate Editor

Prices Of PC Components

You should include a section on the site that specifies the approximate prices of the various components in a PC. A user can thus know whether he is getting the components at the correct prices.

Abhishek Gharpure

Dear Abhishek,
We always mention the prices of the products we test. But it is not possible to mention prices of all products every month, because sales tax and octroi differs in each state. It is difficult to nail down the exact price in different states.

Add to this the grey market prices change almost every day for PCs and their components across the nation. As a result, we can only mention the official MRP of the products supplied to us by the companies for testing purposes.

— Associate Editor

Web Site Woes

I want to thank everyone behind *Digit*. A student of BITS Pilani, I have been a reader for the past three years, and have not missed a single issue.

The February issue was marvellous. I have written to you many times, but have never gotten a response. I want to suggest that you make your Web site more attractive, while providing more information related to upcoming future technologies.

Arun Rana

Dear Arun,
With this letter being answered here, I am sure your gripe of never being answered has been attended to. Thanks for the appreciation regarding our February issue.

Regarding the sprucing up of our Web site (www.thinkdigit.com), we are indeed working on it right now. The thing is, whatever we do, we want to do well. Hence, quite a bit of planning is underway, and efforts are being made to soon give our readers a refreshing new Web site.

— Associate Editor

Call Drops And Infrastructure Concerns

There has been significant development in the field of mobile communications. With incoming calls becoming free and handsets having become cheaper, even *rickshaw-walas* and *dabba-wala bhaiyyas* can afford a cell phone. GSM operators and CDMA operators are now battling it out, but consumers are still bearing the brunt of Access Deficit Charge (ADC). Incessant competition has indeed provided loads of economical benefits, but how about expanding the infrastructure? How about maintaining lines and networks? How about freeing up capacities? How about optimum utilisation of bandwidth? How about connectivity at all times and at all places?

I'm talking about call drops and bad networks. I'm talking about dialling a number you're trying to reach when it matters the most, during peak hours. I'm talking about trying to reach someone registered with other networks. In the trains, call drops are so frequent that a conversation that should last a minute is stretched to five or six minutes as we dial again and again. GPRS on my network is a bad joke.

I am not a telecom engineer, but I am technically inclined enough to understand that networks are not how they should be. In some countries, operators have moved on to Quad-Band and 3G networks, and here we're stuck with single-band networks.

The TRAI and the DOT talk of putting into effect number portability and a unified national tariff. What's the point of focusing on all this if basic call quality is not good enough?

I think it's time the authorities work on guidelines for service providers to provide optimum services and enforce these—to ensure that technical requirements are met and networks are maintained to perfection within the defined coverage areas.

If the telecom companies are here to make money, I think we consumers have the right to get our money's worth, and be able to perform the most basic activities on the cellular phone with confidence.

Aliasgar Raja, Mumbai

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH